ANUSHRI JAIN

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Olin Business School, Washington University in St. Louis | St. Louis, MO 63130

EDUCATION

Washington University in St. Louis, Olin Business School 2021–Present
Ph.D. in Finance

University of California, San Diego 2016–2020
B.S. in Applied Mathematics and Economics (double major); Minor in Finance

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Corporate Finance, Corporate Governance, Labor and Finance

WORKING PAPERS

When Innovation Outpaces Policy: Hyperscale Data Centers and the Fiscal Costs of Investment Incentives

Job Market Paper (Solo Authored)

I study how state tax incentives for data centers affect local public finance, employment, resource markets, and political outcomes. I use staggered incentive adoption and county proximity to water to show that subsidies increase county tax revenues and spending on resident services, particularly schools. Employment rises in industries that complement data centers, but declines overall. As data centers expand, developed-land prices and electricity rates rise, crowding out resource-dependent industries. Local politicians are more likely to be reelected when smaller data centers arrive, but less likely when larger, more resource-intensive facilities enter.

Selected presentations: Olin Finance Brown Bag (2026); Olin Annual Conference Poster Session (2026, scheduled); Boca Finance and Real Estate Conference (2026, scheduled); AFA Poster Session (2027, scheduled)

EPS-Motivated Mergers

with Thomas Bates, Gerald T. Garvey, James Linck, and Todd T. Milbourn

We examine the role of expected EPS accretion or dilution in shaping merger activity. A firm is more likely to be acquired when more potential buyers could increase their earnings per share by purchasing it, even after accounting for other factors known to predict mergers. Firms with more EPS-accretive targets are also more likely to make acquisitions. Our results suggest that EPS incentives remain central in explaining merger activity.

Board Diversity and the Career Progression of Women: Evidence from SB 826

with Rana Mohie El Din

We examine how the gender composition of corporate boards affects women's career opportunities within firms, using California's 2018 board gender quota as a natural experiment. We find increased hiring and promotion of women, with no overall change in exit rates. At the entry level, we find increased hiring and improved retention; in mid-management, we find increased hiring and promotion. Treated firms receive higher Glassdoor ratings, suggesting improvements in workplace policies and practices. The effects on hiring, promotions, and ratings are stronger where female directors serve on board committees and have greater decision-making authority.

Selected presentations: Australasian Finance and Banking Conference (2025); AFA Poster Session (2026); SWFA Conference (2026); FMA European Conference (2026); Econometric Society (2026)*; FMA Annual Meeting (2026); AFA Annual Meeting (2027, scheduled).
* Presented by coauthor.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Acquisition Prospects and Startup Strategy

with Lampros Pnevmatikos and João Dimas

We examine how startups alter product-development and hiring strategies when acquisition becomes less likely. We ask whether they build durable standalone businesses by improving code quality, reducing technical debt and security vulnerabilities, and shifting their workforce toward engineering, or prioritize rapid market entry by adding features and hiring sales and marketing employees while accumulating technical debt.

The Digitalization of Cities: Information Access and Housing Markets

with Danye Wang and Vincent Lin

We study how the digitalization and consolidation of fragmented public records affect house prices and housing market liquidity. We hand collect data on portal launch dates and published records and use the staggered adoption of city open data portals as a natural experiment. We examine whether effects arise through better information about existing amenities and risks or improvements in amenities through lower municipal borrowing costs and better coordination within government.

CONFERENCE DISCUSSIONS

Australasian Finance and Banking Conference 2025
The Glass Cliff: Are Promotions to CEOs Precarious for Women
Paper by Hedda Cui

SWFA Conference 2026
Gender Bias and Financial Activism: How Hedge Funds Shape Mortgage Access for Women
Paper by Maryam Najmi, Bruno R. Arthur, and Monika K. Rabarison

FMA European Conference 2026
Board Gender Diversity and Corporate Carbon Abatement Innovation
Paper by Tinghua Duan, Siyue Guo, and Oskar Kowalewski

SUMMER SCHOOLS

Summer School on Structural Estimation in Corporate Finance 2025

TEACHING ASSISTANT EXPERIENCE

Capital Markets and Financial Management (UG, MSF) 2026
International Finance (UG) 2025
Financial Technology: Methods and Practice (MSF) 2025
Investment Theory (MSF) 2024
Mergers and Acquisitions (UG, MBA, MSF) 2022–2024
Advanced Valuation (UG) 2023–2024
Advanced Corporate Financial Strategy (MBA, MSF) 2023–2024
Advanced Financial Management (UG) 2022–2023
Advanced Corporate Finance I – Valuation (MBA, MSF) 2023
Introduction to Corporate Finance (Ph.D.) 2023

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Todd Gormley - Washington University in St. Louis Sep 2023–Sep 2024
Research Assistant, Marta Serra-Garcia - University of California, San Diego Sep 2019–Jun 2020
Research Assistant, Wendy Liu - University of California, San Diego Jun 2017–Feb 2018

HONORS AND AWARDS

Moog Scholar Award ($1,400) 2025
Olin Business School Research Grant ($500) 2025
Bright Initiative Research Grant ($15,000) 2023–2024
Doctoral Fellowship, Olin Business School, Washington University in St. Louis 2021–Present
Distinguished Senior Service Award, University of California, San Diego 2020
Tom Tucker Leadership Scholarship, University of California, San Diego ($10,000) 2018–2019
Oceanids Award, University of California, San Diego ($1,000) 2018–2019

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Financial Analyst – Finance Rotation Program Sep 2020–Sep 2021
Microsoft Corporation, Redmond, WA

Financial Analyst Intern Jun 2019–Sep 2019
Oracle Corporation, Redwood Shores, CA

Financial Analyst Intern Jun 2018–Sep 2018
Oracle Corporation, Redwood Shores, CA

Data Analyst Intern Jun 2017–Sep 2017
Facebook/Trinamix Inc., Menlo Park, CA

SKILLS AND ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Computing: Python (advanced), Stata (advanced), R (intermediate)
Languages: English (bilingual), Hindi (bilingual), Spanish (intermediate), Japanese (intermediate)
Citizenship: United States

REFERENCES

Todd Gormley (Chair)
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